

7.2. Policies

7.2.1. Definition of Place, Curtilage and Setting

For planning purposes, it is useful to clearly define a place and its setting. In conservation terms, the setting of a place is the *"environment of a place that is part of or contributes to its significance and distinctive character."* (Burra Charter Article 1.12)

Policy 1: The place and curtilage should be defined as that part of the Edina estate which became the War Memorial Hospital in 1922 (see Figure 11). The setting should be defined as the original Edina estate boundaries and the streets which surround those boundaries: Bronte Road, Birrell Street, Church Street, and Carrington Street.

Policy 2: The name of the place *"Waverley War Memorial Hospital"* should continue to refer to the nature of the original hospital's establishment as a memorial to the First World War.

7.2.2. Significant Fabric, Views, Spaces and Spatial Relationships

Much of the significance of a place is derived from its fabric. The term fabric is intended to include broadly the landform, landscape, plantings and vegetation, buildings and other site features, as well as views and spatial relationships. Defining the significant fabric helps in making decisions about the conservation of a place and in making sensitive changes to the place.

Policy 3: The fabric, views and spatial relationships ranked Exceptional and High should be conserved. They are:

- Victorian buildings and estate planning: topography, plantings, fences, statuary and spatial order (including the private street, original drive and distinction of service areas (stables and kitchen) from formal areas;
- War Memorial Hospital buildings of aesthetic importance: main building, chapel;
- 1920s landscape items: palm trees, cast iron bollards, reconfigured gates to Birrell Street / Bronte Road and new gates to Carrington Road;
- External views from Centennial Park of the Norfolk Island Pines;
- Existing views of the houses along Birrell Street and tower from Carrington Street (views 1, 2, 3 in Figure 11).

7.2.3. Uses and Governance

Use can form part of the significance of a place, especially when it is a historic use which is continuing. Conservation is aided by selecting a use for each space which is able to be accommodated with only minimal change to the significant fabric.

The medical / health care use which took over the private residential use in 1922 is of such long standing and significance in its own right that the medical use may by now be considered a historic use.

Policy 4: The existing institutional governance and hospital use is a historic use that should be continued.

Policy 5: The historic use should be broadly defined to include uses related to health, aged care and training.